

Table 1. Baseline characteristics by neoadjuvant anti-HER2 regimen. Synthetic data for teaching.

Characteristic	Overall N = 615 ¹	Trastuzumab + pertuzumab N = 416 ¹	Trastuzumab alone N = 199 ¹	SMD ²
Age at diagnosis, years	50.9 (43.5–58.4)	50.7 (43.8–59.1)	51.5 (42.6–57.7)	0.05
Missing	1	1	0	
Menopausal status				0.05
Premenopausal	267 (43.4%)	184 (44.2%)	83 (41.7%)	
Postmenopausal	348 (56.6%)	232 (55.8%)	116 (58.3%)	
ECOG performance status				0.10
0	450 (73.2%)	309 (74.3%)	141 (70.9%)	
1	154 (25.0%)	101 (24.3%)	53 (26.6%)	
2	11 (1.8%)	6 (1.4%)	5 (2.5%)	
BMI, kg/m ²	24.1 (21.3–26.7)	24.1 (21.5–26.9)	24.0 (21.2–26.4)	0.08
Baseline LVEF, %	65.0 (61.0–68.0)	65.0 (61.0–68.0)	65.0 (62.0–68.0)	-0.08
Clinical T category				0.09
T1	49 (8.0%)	32 (7.7%)	17 (8.5%)	
T2	348 (56.6%)	237 (57.0%)	111 (55.8%)	
T3	139 (22.6%)	97 (23.3%)	42 (21.1%)	
T4	79 (12.8%)	50 (12.0%)	29 (14.6%)	
Clinical N category				0.00
N0	180 (29.3%)	122 (29.3%)	58 (29.1%)	
N1	290 (47.2%)	196 (47.1%)	94 (47.2%)	
N2	83 (13.5%)	56 (13.5%)	27 (13.6%)	
N3	62 (10.1%)	42 (10.1%)	20 (10.1%)	
Clinical stage (AJCC 8th, anatomic)				0.10
IIA	139 (22.6%)	94 (22.6%)	45 (22.6%)	
IIB	208 (33.8%)	141 (33.9%)	67 (33.7%)	
IIIA	134 (21.8%)	94 (22.6%)	40 (20.1%)	
IIIB	72 (11.7%)	45 (10.8%)	27 (13.6%)	
IIIC	62 (10.1%)	42 (10.1%)	20 (10.1%)	
Hormone receptor (ER or PR ≥1%)				0.01
Positive	356 (57.9%)	240 (57.7%)	116 (58.3%)	
Negative	259 (42.1%)	176 (42.3%)	83 (41.7%)	
HER2 status				0.02
IHC 3+	475 (77.2%)	320 (76.9%)	155 (77.9%)	
IHC 2+, ISH amplified	140 (22.8%)	96 (23.1%)	44 (22.1%)	
Histologic grade				0.07
1	22 (3.9%)	15 (3.9%)	7 (3.9%)	
2	257 (45.2%)	171 (44.2%)	86 (47.5%)	
3	289 (50.9%)	201 (51.9%)	88 (48.6%)	
Missing	47	29	18	
Ki-67, %	43.5 (31.0–56.0)	43.5 (31.0–56.0)	43.5 (30.0–57.0)	-0.05
Missing	71	54	17	
Neoadjuvant chemotherapy backbone				0.55
Anthracycline-based	223 (36.3%)	116 (27.9%)	107 (53.8%)	
Carboplatin-based	392 (63.7%)	300 (72.1%)	92 (46.2%)	
Year of neoadjuvant therapy start				2.80
2012–2015	162 (26.3%)	6 (1.4%)	156 (78.4%)	
2016–2019	209 (34.0%)	171 (41.1%)	38 (19.1%)	
2020–2023	244 (39.7%)	239 (57.5%)	5 (2.5%)	

¹Median (IQR) or n (%).

²Standardized mean difference; ISMDI < 0.1 indicates balance.

Carboplatin-based: carboplatin without an anthracycline.